Counting Every Voice: Building Better Evidence for Northern Communities

About

Canadian municipalities conduct local surveys to inform immigrant settlement strategies, but a standardized methodological framework is lacking. This project reviews 33 local immigrant survey reports, presents the current methodological practices and evaluates the quality of generated evidence from these surveys.

Search Framework & Methodology

- Systematic internet search for local immigrant survey reports
- Extraction of key details e.g., sample size, country of origin, data collection challenges
- Comparison of sample size to the required sample size
- Comparison with Census data for survey deviation
- Examination of area-level and survey implementation characteristics to find factors associated with deviation.

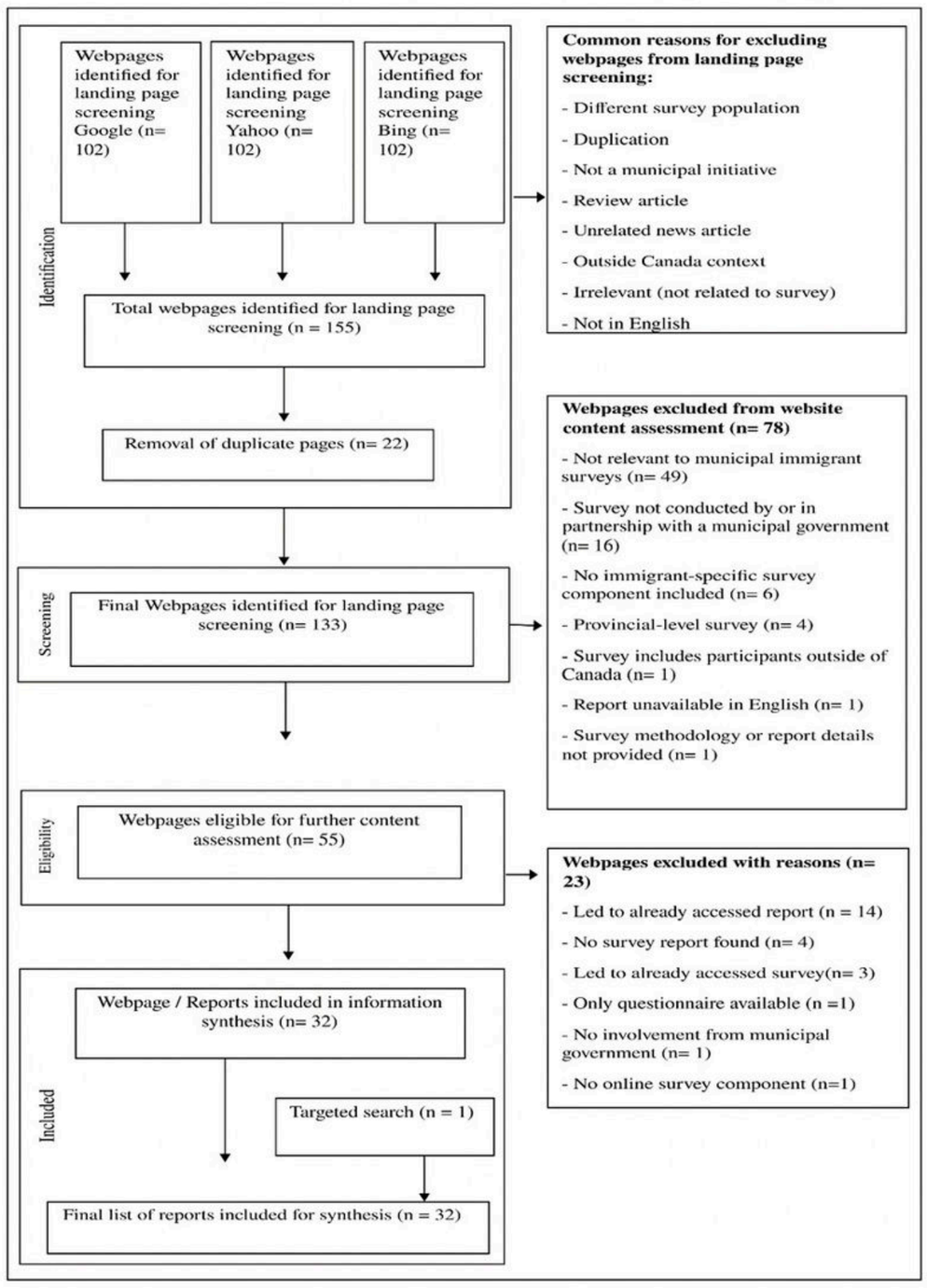


Figure: PRISMA Framework for evidence synthesis

Findings

Municipality name	Economic-to-Family Admission (%)	Economic-to-Refugee Admission (%)	Family-to-Refugee Admission (%)
Waterloo	43%	44%	2%
Waterloo	42%	12%	95%
Waterloo	14%	21%	8%
Peterborough	74%	55%	69%
Peterborough	39%	35%	7%
Peterborough	26%	23%	4%
Calgary	63%	37%	71%
Calgary	63%	46%	46%
Calgary	51%	73%	255%
Chatham-Kent	23%	25%	3%
Chatham-Kent	23%	7%	21%
Guelph-Wellington	25%	37%	16%
Guelph-Wellington	19%	57%	47%
Huron*	1%	974%	961%
Perth	36%	41%	8%
Huron-Perth	21%	33%	15%
Hamilton	40%	67%	46%
St Thomas-Elgin	15%	26%	48%
Moncton	NA	441%	NA
Cape Breton	3%	70%	71%
Grey Bruce	19%	3%	20%
Langley	61%	34%	70%
Winnipeg	60%	19%	25%
Delta	16%	52%	43%

Table 1: Deviation of sample data from official statistics

Characteristic	N	Spearman's ρ	BH-adjusted q
Panel A. Survey implementation characteristics			
Below sampling benchmark	23	0.083	0.717
No translation beyond EN/FR	23	0.114	0.717
Short survey window (<30 days)	21	-0.326	0.410
Digital-only promotion	22	-0.157	0.717
No incentive offered	23	-0.094	0.717
Significant bots/suspicious responses	23	-0.217	0.652
High incomplete/ineligible rate	23	0.318	0.410
No strengthening strategy	23	-0.311	0.410
Overall block test	20	—	—
Panel B. Area-level population characteristics			
Share of immigrants (%)	23	0.369	0.098
Share of non-permanent residents (%)	23	0.432	0.092
No knowledge of English/French (%)	23	0.270	0.212
Labour force participation rate (%)	23	0.369	0.098
Postsecondary education rate (%)	23	0.559	0.043*
Visible minority share (%)	23	0.497	0.058
Total population	23	0.393	0.098
Overall block test	23	—	—

Table 2: Deviation of sample data from official statistics

- 18 of the 23 surveys (78%) showed major divergence from census benchmarks in at least one category.
- Across all surveys, 39 of 64 comparison points (58%) were classified as major deviations.

- No evidence of a collective association between the measured implementation characteristics and survey deviation
- By contrast, the area-level characteristics were collectively associated with survey deviation

Status: Under Review in the method, data, analyses

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